

PSYCHOLOGY 101 · RECITATION HOMEWORK

Homework 1: What a Baby Already Knows

Name: _____

Date: _____

Instructions: About 20 minutes. You'll think like a baby scientist: since babies can't talk, every question here comes down to what you could MEASURE. Total: 22 points.

Part A — Design an experiment

1. You want to find out whether a newborn recognizes her father's voice. Describe an experiment: what would you play for the baby, and what would you measure to tell whether she recognizes it? (3 pts)

Part B — Match the method to what it measures

2. Draw a line from each baby-science method to what it tells us. (4 pts)

Looking time	Whether a baby is startled or calmed by something
Sucking rate	Which direction a sound or smell is coming from
Heart rate change	Which of two sounds a baby prefers to hear
Head turning	Whether a baby finds something new or interesting

Part C — True or false?

3. Write TRUE or FALSE for each statement about newborns. (4 pts)

Statement	True or false?
A baby can hear its mother's voice before it is born.	
A newborn can see clearly all the way across a room.	
Newborns look longer at face-like patterns than at scrambled ones.	
Babies don't feel pain until they are about one year old.	

Part D — Invent a score (Statistics flashback)

4. Dr. Apgar turned 'how is this baby?' into a number. Invent a tiny COMFORT score for a NICU baby using two signs you could see. Fill in what 0, 1, and 2 points would look like for each sign. (2 pts)

Sign	0 points	1 point	2 points

Part E — Faces

5. Draw two simple ovals. In the first, put two dots and a mouth-line where a face's eyes and mouth go. In the second, put the same dots and line in scrambled places. Circle the one a newborn would look at longer. (2 pts)

6. Why is kangaroo care called brain care? (1 pt)

☐

A. Calm skin-to-skin contact steadies stress, sleep, and heart rate while the brain is wiring fast.

☐

B. The parent's warmth directly makes brain cells multiply faster.

☐

C. It keeps the baby awake longer, and brains only grow while awake.

☐

D. It means the baby no longer needs to hear voices.

Part F — Flashback

7. From NICU Tutor: name TWO things kangaroo care does for a baby. (2 pts)

8. From Genetics: identical twins share exactly the same _____. (1 pt)

Part G — Think like a doctor

9. You are designing a new NICU. Name THREE things you would change about a typical hospital room to make it gentler for preemies' developing brains, and say why each helps. (3 pts)

Score: _____ / 22 points

Professor's comment:
